

Submissions of New Applications and Opinions To DSREC**Appendix 2.1****Application form for ethical approval of a Research Project****Instructions :**

- 1) Submit one (1) original and one (1) copy of the research proposal, in addition to one electronic copy to office of the Dubai Scientific Research Ethics Committee (DSREC)
- 2) Instructions to fill the application form
 - a) The application must be clearly legible
 - b) Typing is recommended
 - c) The modification of the original content of the form is strictly prohibited.
 - d) All sections of the application form must be completed
 - e) Write "Not Applicable" wherever appropriate

1) Project Title :**Full Title**

Factors Associated with Hospital Admission Among Patients Presenting with Abdominal Pain:
A Retrospective Analysis of Electronic Health Record Data from King's College Hospital
Dubai

Short Title/Protocol Number (If applicable):

To investigate demographic, clinical, laboratory, and imaging factors associated with hospital admission among patients presenting with abdominal pain.

2) Is the study required to be recorded in Electronic Medical Record (EMR) system of Dubai Health Authority (DHA)?

Yes ☐ No ☒

If yes, please provide:

i. **EMR Title:**

ii. ***EMR Description:**

(Do not exceed more than 200 words)

NOTE:

***EMR Description: Is a description of a study, which can be viewed by all Salama Access users in DHA.**

****Applicable to ONLY prospective studies conducted by DHA Staff**

3) Type of the Project :

- ☐ Drug Study
 ☐ Device Study
 ☒ Chart/Records Review
- ☐ Biomedical Research
 ☒ Health Related Research
 ☐ Community-Based
- ☐ Social and Behavior Research
 ☐ Other: -----

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4) Principal Investigator (only one researcher should be appointed as PI):

Title/Name

Designation

Unit/Department

Institution

Email

Contact No.

Office:

Mobile:

☐ **CV attached**

Note: Students cannot be principal investigators on a study

4) Co-Investigators and study site staff:

Yes ☐ No ☐ if checked NO, provide the reason

Title	Name	Designation and Role in the study	CV Attached	E-mail & Contact No	Unit / Department	EMR Access Yes/No
Mr.	Hussain Sarfraz	Student Researcher	Yes	hsarfraz76@gmail.com +966596886639	Intern	No

5) Site Contact Person:

Title/Name

Tel. Office

Fax

Mobile

Email

Submissions of New Applications and Opinions To DSREC*Emergency no.***6) Does investigator or key personnel have any conflict of interest in this study?**☐ Yes ☒ No

If yes, please explain:

7) Has this research proposal been approved by an Institutional Review Board (IRB) or Research Ethics Committee elsewhere?☐ Yes ☒ No

If 'Yes', please provide the following information: (Please attach a copy)

a. Name of institution that reviewed this research proposal**b.** Address of reviewing institution**8) Has this study been done elsewhere?**☐ Yes ☒ No

If 'Yes', how does this differ from the ones done earlier.

9) Proposed starting date of the study**Proposed completion date of the study**

06/19/2026

06/30/2026

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10) Is this a multicenter trial?

☐

Yes

☒

No

If yes, which are the other centers involved?

Location(s) within UAE where the research is to be conducted:

11) Will this study/research involve human subjects?

☒

Yes

☐

No

☐

Not applicable

If 'Yes', will you have direct contact or intervention with them?

(e.g., as subject's physician; in obtaining samples directly from the subject; by interviewing the subject?)

☐

Yes

☒

No

12) Goals of the research

Summarize the background and hypothesis of the study.

a) What are the primary and secondary objectives of the study?

b) Why is this research important? What contributions will it make?

This study will analyze anonymized electronic health record data provided by King's College Hospital Dubai to explore patterns in patient characteristics, clinical variables, and health outcomes. The primary objective is to perform exploratory and statistical analysis of clinical and demographic variables to identify potential associations with key health outcomes. The secondary objective is to assess data quality, missingness, and variable structure in order to prepare the dataset for future predictive or inferential modelling.

This research contributes to understanding real-world hospital data and supports evidence-based insights that may improve clinical decision-making and resource planning.

13) Participants

a) Research population and sample size calculation

Population: patients treated at King's College Hospital Dubai

Sample Size: 957

b) Expected total number of participants in the study and expected total number of participants at DHA site.

The study will include all anonymised patient records available in the dataset provided by King's College Hospital Dubai. The expected sample size is therefore dependent on the total number of records contained in the dataset and is anticipated to be several hundred to several thousand patients. The expected number of participants at the DHA site is not applicable, as this study uses a pre-existing anonymised dataset and does not involve data collection from multiple active sites.

c) Age range of participants

14-96

Participants will be included based on the availability of anonymized records in the dataset provided by King's College Hospital Dubai. All eligible records within the dataset will be included in the analysis. No recruitment or direct patient selection will take place.

d) How will participants be included in the study?

Submissions of New Applications and Opinions To DSREC*(If randomization is used, please explain how this will be done)*

- e) How much time will a subject have to dedicate to the project beyond that needed for standard Treatment? There is no additional time required from subjects, as this is a retrospective analysis of anonymised patient records. No direct patient involvement or intervention will occur.
- f) If normal volunteers are involved, please explain how many will be selected and the method of selection employed? Not applicable. This study does not involve recruitment of normal volunteers, as it is based solely on anonymized retrospective clinical data.

14) This project will involve the following subject types: (check mark types to be studied)

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☒ Normal Volunteers | ☐ Subjects Incapable of giving Consent |
| ☐ In Patients | ☐ <u>Prisoners or Institutionalized Individuals</u> |
| ☐ Out Patients | ☐ Fetuses |
| ☐ Patient Controls | ☐ Infants (0 -3 Y) |
| ☐ Students | ☐ Children (3-12Y) |
| ☐ Cognitively Disabled | ☒ <u>Minors (Under Age 18)</u> |
| ☐ Physically Disabled | ☒ Over Age 60 |
| ☐ Pregnant Women | ☐ Other Potentially Elevated Risk Populations |

15) What are the inclusion criteria?

Patients contained within the anonymised dataset provided by King's College Hospital Dubai

16) What are the exclusion criteria?

Records with substantial missing data in key variables required for analysis.

17) Does this project call for: (Check mark all that apply to this study)

Use of Voice, Video, Digital, or Image Recordings?

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- ☐ Advertising for subjects?
 - ☐ More than Minimal Risk?
 - ☐ More than Minimal Psychological Stress?
 - ☐ Extra Costs to the subjects (tests, hospitalization, etc.)?

18) Does the project require the examination or the use of patient's medical records?

☐ Yes ☐ No

19) Are there any predictable risks to the subjects of physical or psychological pain or discomfort, or risk of injury of any kind?

☐ Yes

☐ No

☐ Cannot predict

If ‘Yes’ or “Cannot predict”, describe the possible areas of risk. Outline briefly any steps taken to minimize the possibility of pain, discomfort or injury and procedures for determining levels of discomfort at which you will terminate the participation by the subject in the research:

20) This project involves the use of:(Check mark all that apply to this study)

- a. ☐ An Investigational New Drug (IND) or an approved drug for an unapproved indication.
Drug name and company
- b. ☐ An Investigational Medical Device or an Approved Medical Device For An Unapproved Use
Device name and manufacturer
- c. ☐ Radiation or Radioisotopes
- d. ☐ Blood: Total Amount of Blood
Over Time Period (days)
- e. ☐ rDNA or Biohazardous materials

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f. ☐ Human Tissue or Cell Lines

21) If a drug or a device will be used for the study:

1. Is the drug or the device approved (registered) by DHA or MOH?

☐ Yes ☐ No

If No,

- is the drug or the device approved by any major International Organizations, e.g. FDA, EMEA.
☐ Yes ☐ No
- is the documentation on the provision of the unregistered drug or the device to the site is submitted
☐ Yes ☐ No (If no please provide the explanation)
- is the MOH UAE declaration for the entry of the unregistered drug or the device is submitted
☐ Yes ☐ No (If no please provide the explanation)

2. Provide details of any known side effects, which may result from the investigational drug or device.

3. If it is a drug, what phase of research the drug has reached to date?

☐ Phase 3 ☐ Post marketing study

22) Is this a double-blind study

☐ Yes ☒ No

If yes,

- a) Is the code for unblinding in case of emergency available at both the investigator (e.g hospital) and sponsor sites?
- b) Format in which code breaks for clinical trials are supplied
 - ☐ Sealed envelopes
 - ☐ Scratch cards
 - ☐ Tear off label on the drug container which will be removed when dispensing the trial drug and place on the drug accountability form
 - ☐ Interactive voice response system – user identity and password is required to access such a system
 - ☐ 24 hour telephone number provided by the sponsor

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23) Please specify any incentives, compensation or treatment the participants will receive through participation in this study.

24) Does the project require special data collection (e.g., interview, questionnaire, case record forms)?

☐ Yes

☐ No

If yes, please attach a copy.

25) What special training or qualifications are required for data gatherers? Who will provide training?

☐ ICH GCP

 Certificate provide Yes ☐

 No ☐
☐ NIH

 Certificate provide Yes ☐

 No ☐
☐ Other (Specify)

 Certificate provide Yes ☐

 No ☐

26) Data Handling

a. Who will have access to the data?

Hussain Sarfraz (student researcher) and Salman Muhammad Soomar (research supervisor, King's College Hospital Dubai).

b. Will all personally identifying data be held confidential?



Yes



No

c. Does the project require the linkage of project data on available subjects with other individually identifying data from outside the facility or division?



Yes



No

If yes, describe the other data sources and types of data used:

d. What steps are being taken or will be taken to ensure that no information that may identify an individual be released?

Direct patient identifiers, including the Medical Record Number (MRN), were removed from the dataset before analysis. Results will be reported only in aggregate form through summary statistics, tables, and visualizations. No individual patient records will be presented in the report or published outputs.

e. How will the subjects' rights to privacy and safety be protected? Describe measures that will be taken to protect the confidentiality of data containing patient-identifying information.

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his capstone project. Any future use beyond the scope of this protocol would require appropriate approval from King's College Hospi

f. Will any patient identifiable information be provided to an external study sponsor?

☐ Yes

☒ No

☐ N/A, there is no external study sponsor

g. What are the plans for future use of the data (beyond that described in the protocol, if any).

27) Do you anticipate that this research will be used for a commercial purpose?

☐ Yes

☒ No

(If “yes”, explain how you will describe this to the participants in the consent process and to the DSREC

28) Anonymity and Confidentiality

a) Will the anonymity (*protection of the identity of participants*) of participants be protected?

☒ Yes (completely)

☐ Yes (partially)

☐ No

If “yes”, how will anonymity be protected and how will this be explained in the consent process?

Participant anonymity will be protected through the use of anonymized data. No names, contact information, medical record numbers, or other direct identifiers will be included in the analytical dataset. Results will be reported only in aggregate form and no individual participant will be identifiable.

If “no”, justify why loss of anonymity is required and explain how this will be explained in the consent process

b) Will you provide confidentiality (*protection, access, control and security of the data and personal information*) to the participants and their data? ☒ Yes ☐ No

If “yes”, how will confidentiality be protected and how will this be explained in the consent process?

The dataset provided to the researcher has been de-identified through removal of direct identifiers such as MRN. The researcher has no ability to identify individual patients. Study findings will only be reported in aggregated form.

If “no”, justify the lack of confidentiality and explain how this will be explained in the consent process.

29) Informed Consent. It is DSREC’s policy to have written consent for all projects involving human participants.

Please ensure that each item on the DSREC **Consent Form Checklist** (Appendix 2.3) has been included on the consent form and that a copy of the proposed consent form, with its Arabic translation, is attached. Further languages of the consent form could be submitted.

30) If a signed written consent will not be obtained, explain what you will do instead and why?

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31) What are the provisions made to obtain informed consents in case the participant is a minors or adults incapable of giving consent for themselves?

32) Is this project sponsored/funded?

☐

Yes

☒

No

a) Nature of Funding:

☐

Grant

☐

Contract/Agreement

☐

Other

b) Full name of sponsor / funding source:

c) Contract/agreement/grant (attach a copy)

Head of Department of Study Site

Departmental Approval:

I have read this application and believe it to be scientifically and ethically sound. I approve the research design. I give my consent for the application to be forwarded to the Dubai Scientific Research Ethics Committee with my recommendation that it be approved.

Signature of Head of Department:

(print name)

(date)

(signature)

And

Signature of Chair Ethics Committee:

(print name)

(date)

(signature)

Principal Investigator

Your signature indicates that you agree to abide by all policies, procedures, regulations and laws governing the ethical conduct of research involving humans.

Hussain Sarfraz



(print name)

(date)

(signature)

06/20/2026